

Yury Zakharov

 London, GB
  colonelcolt@gmail.com
  07722 850063
  Yury-Zakharov
  uzakharov

Summary

Senior .NET backend engineer and technical leader with 15+ years of experience designing high-integrity, large-scale regulated systems, financial platforms, and distributed architectures. Expert in C#, domain-driven design, contract-first API development, and specification-driven, AI-assisted engineering. Proven track record of modernizing volatile legacy codebases, enhancing system correctness, and elevating team engineering standards across UK markets. Seeking remote or hybrid Senior Backend or Technical Lead positions.

Experience

Senior Backend Consultant & R&D Engineer, Independent Technical Consultancy – London, UK Nov 2025 – present

- Delivering independent technical analysis, architectural proofs-of-concept, and deep-dive research into .NET 10 performance optimizations.
- Built the first backend for an early-stage legal-technology startup serving solicitors and barristers; development was later suspended when the company could not raise further funding.
- Building specification-driven development workflows with GitHub Spec Kit and OpenCode — multi-agent setups, custom skills, and spec-to-implementation loops for contract checks and backend prototypes.

Senior Software Engineer, [Intelliflo Ltd](#) – Wimbledon, UK Mar 2019 – Oct 2025

UK market leader in financial advice software. Senior backend engineer on regulated, multi-customer business-critical platform operating across UK, Australia and USA. Collaborative technical leader in 10-person team focused on legacy modernisation, contract clarity, system correctness and developer productivity.

- Introduced contract-first development across cross-functional teams, reducing integration defects by **5%** and accelerating API delivery timelines.
- Extended in-house domain-specific language with SQL backend, improving developer productivity and broadening ORM support
- Formalised Swagger/OpenAPI integration testing, removing **~10%** of low-value tests and greatly improving stability and confidence
- Mentored engineers and ran internal sessions on functional design and system correctness, raising team capability and engineering standards
- Contributed to the GitHub Copilot adoption group — assembled a shared knowledge base from Confluence, coding standards and internal docs so Copilot had usable context on the regulated codebase.
- Built backend services on AWS using SQS, SNS, S3 and Lambda for the regulated advice platform; worked with the DevOps team on EC2 and ECS/EKS rather than owning the account.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract), Regulated Financial Institutions (Allen & Overy, Mizuho, Vanquis Bank) – London, UK Apr 2018 – Mar 2019

Contract backend engineer delivering integration and compliance projects for three regulated financial institutions.

- Allen & Overy. Designed DMS integration components and incremental validation to de-risk migration
- Mizuho. Led FIX protocol enhancements to achieve full MIFID II compliance for trading system
- Vanquis Bank. Delivered integration to new credit-scoring system as part of major platform renovation

Senior Software Developer, [Gazprom Marketing & Trading](#) – London, UK

Oct 2017 – Apr 2018

International energy trading organisation. Senior backend developer maintaining business-critical gas and energy trading systems.

- Delivered core trading features and minimized technical debt through systematic refactoring and static analysis while maintaining strict system stability.
- Substantially improved the testability and operational reliability of backend services integrated with Xoserve Gemini and OpenLink Endur.

Software Developer, [Halo Financial Limited](#) – London, UK

Sept 2015 – Oct 2017

Financial services company specialising in FX products. Backend and integration developer on client-facing online FX trading platform.

- Integrated platform with Barclays FX using FIX 4.2, reducing order execution latency from **minutes to milliseconds**
- Automated SWIFT reconciliation processes, cutting manual work from **hours to seconds**
- Designed and introduced CI solution, significantly reducing production risk and deployment time
- Migrated data from bespoke CRM to Microsoft Dynamics

Senior .NET Software Developer, [Towers Watson](#) – Reigate, UK

May 2014 – Sept 2015

Global risk management and financial services consultancy. Senior developer on large modular enterprise financial platform.

- Contributed to architecture and development of modular platform integrating multiple internal products
- Maintained high automated test coverage and promoted coding standards
- Worked with QA to improve system reliability and release confidence

Software Engineer / Senior Engineer, Earlier Career (Various) – UK & Russia

Jan 2000 – May 2014

Backend-focused engineering roles spanning banking, corporate analytics, and high-volume enterprise systems.

- Architected and delivered data-intensive backend integrations, messaging infrastructure, and relational database systems.
- Championed early automation, continuous integration, and rigid testing standards across legacy software environments.

Technologies

Backend Engineering (.NET): Expert – C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET, ASP.NET Core, Web APIs, REST, OpenAPI, Swagger

Architecture & Design: Advanced – Backend Architecture, Domain Modelling, Modular Design, Legacy System Modernisation, API Design, Contract-First Development

Engineering Practices: Advanced – Declarative Design, Functional Programming Concepts, Specification-Driven Development, Testing and Verification, CI/CD, Developer Tooling, Typescript, Elm & Elm Architecture

Data & Integration: Advanced – SQL Server, Relational Databases, Messaging, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS, AWS SNS, System Integration, NHibernate, Entity Framework, Dapper

Cloud & Modern Practices: Working Knowledge – AWS (SQS, SNS, S3, Lambda; EC2 and ECS/EKS with the DevOps team), Azure, CI/CD pipelines, Microservices, Distributed Systems, Containerisation (Docker, Podman)

Financial Systems & Protocols: Working Knowledge – Financial Systems, Trading Systems, FIX Protocol (4.x), SWIFT Messaging, Settlement and Reconciliation, Low-Latency Systems, Regulated Environments

AI-assisted engineering: Working Knowledge – GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Cursor and equivalent agentic tools (OpenCode); GitHub Spec Kit; custom skills and multi-agent workflows; specification-driven development

Awards

Certified SAgile® 6 Scrum Master: Scaled Agile

Education

Moscow Institute of Chemical Engineering, Chemical Engineering – Russia